ScentStrip: A Wearable Fragrance Strip for Everyday Life

A Research Paper on the Science, the Market and the Business Model

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Abstract

Perfume is expensive, it fades within hours on skin, and it comes in a fragile glass bottle that is hard to carry. I think the format itself is the problem, not the fragrance. ScentStrip is my answer: a thin, solid strip of fragrance that sticks to the inside of your clothes, warms up with your body, and releases scent slowly through the day. You peel it off at night and use a fresh one tomorrow.

In this paper I explain where the idea came from, the science behind it, how I built my first prototype, and the problems I found along the way. I also look at the size of the fragrance market in India and around the world, who already sells something similar, and how ScentStrip could make money.

I want to be honest about where things stand. ScentStrip is not a proven product yet. My landing page has been live since June 2026 and has a real feedback form connected to a database I built, but I have only collected one real response so far. The biggest open question is whether a solid strip can smell strong enough to compete with a spray. This paper is my plan for answering that question with real tests and real people before I spend serious money.

The idea in one sentence

ScentStrip is a 70 mm by 25 mm glycerin strip loaded with Eau de Parfum strength fragrance oil that sticks inside your collar or waistband and gives you 6 to 8 hours of scent for about ₹28 to ₹50 a day.

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1. Introduction: Why I Started This

I build things to find out if I am right. Dhandha, which means business in Gujarati, is my public lab: every idea I believe in gets a landing page, a feedback form and an honest result. ScentStrip is the first idea on that board, and it started with a simple frustration.

A good perfume in India costs anywhere from ₹2,000 to ₹15,000. If you use it every day, a bottle is gone in weeks. You spray it in the morning and by lunch it has mostly faded. If you carry it in your bag, the glass can break. The format has barely changed in a hundred years: a glass bottle, a pump, and a liquid that is mostly alcohol.

1.1 The three problems I wanted to solve

Problem	What it looks like in real life
It is expensive	A designer bottle costs ₹6,000 to ₹20,000. Most people cannot afford to use it freely every day, so they save it for special days. Cheap sprays exist, but they usually smell weaker and fade faster.
It does not last	Fragrance sprayed on skin evaporates quickly because skin is warm, oily and always moving. By the time it matters most, in a meeting or at dinner, the scent is gone.
It is hard to carry	Glass bottles are heavy and can break. Travel sizes cost more per ml. You cannot easily reapply during a long day, at the gym or on a flight.

My question was: what if the fragrance did not have to be a liquid at all? What if it could be a solid that you wear, like a small patch on your clothes, that releases scent slowly all day?

2. What ScentStrip Is

ScentStrip is a thin, flexible strip made of a glycerin base that holds fragrance oil. One side has a gentle, repositionable adhesive. You stick it on the inside of your clothes where nobody can see it, and your body heat slowly warms it so the scent comes out over the day.

2.1 How you use it

1. **Peel.** Lift the backing paper to expose the adhesive. This takes about two seconds.
2. **Place.** Press it onto the inside of your collar, your waistband or an inner hem. The collar is the best spot because it sits close to your neck, which is warm, and close to your nose.
3. **Wear.** Your body heat warms the strip and the fragrance comes out slowly through the day.
4. **Peel off.** At night, peel it off cleanly. There should be no sticky residue and no stain. Tomorrow you use a fresh strip.

2.2 Product specifications

Feature	My target
Size	70 mm long, 25 mm wide, 2 to 3 mm thick
Carrier material	Clear glycerin melt and pour soap base
Fragrance load	15 to 25 percent fragrance oil by weight (my first formula is about 22 percent)
Adhesive	Repositionable microsphere acrylic adhesive, the same kind of idea as a Post-it note
Backing	Silicone release liner that you peel off before use
Wear time	6 to 8 hours of noticeable scent (target, not yet proven)
Pack	7 strips in a compact foil pack, one week of daily use
Price target	₹199 to ₹349 per 7 strip pack
Launch scents	Sandalwood, Oud and Fresh Linen (simple, one or two note scents)

2.3 Why a strip and not a device

Early on I looked at two options. Option A was a disposable strip. Option B was a small reusable clip that holds a refillable scent core. The clip has better long term money (you sell the clip once and then sell refills), but it needs injection molding, more design work and much more money up front.

I chose the strip first. It is cheaper to make, faster to test, and if people do not want it, I lose very little. If the strip works, the money and the customer feedback from it can pay for the clip later. Start simple, prove demand, then upgrade.

3. The Science Behind It

I do not have a chemistry degree, so I had to learn this from the ground up. Here is the science in the simplest words I can find, and how each part connects to ScentStrip.

3.1 How we smell anything

Smell is chemistry in the air. A fragrance is made of many different molecules. When a molecule evaporates, it floats into the air, reaches your nose, and your brain reads it as a smell. So the whole job of a perfume, or a strip, is to put the right molecules into the air at the right speed.

If the molecules evaporate too fast, you get a strong smell for a short time and then nothing. If they evaporate too slowly, you barely smell anything. A good fragrance product is really a

controlled evaporation system. That is the key idea behind ScentStrip: instead of dumping all the fragrance on you at once like a spray, the strip lets it out slowly.

3.2 The scent pyramid

Perfumers describe a fragrance in three layers called notes. They are sorted by how fast their molecules evaporate. Small, light molecules evaporate first. Big, heavy molecules evaporate last and stay the longest.

Layer	What it is	Examples	Rough timing
Top notes	Small, light molecules. The first thing you smell.	Bergamot, lemon, grapefruit, mint	First minutes to about 2 hours
Heart notes	Medium molecules. The main character of the scent.	Rose, jasmine, cardamom, cinnamon	After the top notes fade, for a few hours
Base notes	Large, heavy molecules that evaporate slowly and hold the lighter notes in place.	Oud, sandalwood, cedar, musk, amber	Several hours, some can last more than a day

One thing I learned while researching: sources do not agree on exact times. My website says heart notes last 3 to 5 hours, but Wikipedia says they can fade in under an hour on skin. The honest answer is that it depends on the fragrance, the surface and the temperature. What everyone agrees on is the order: top first, base last.

This is also why I picked **sandalwood and oud** for my first prototype. They are base note materials. Heavy molecules evaporate slowly, which suits a product that needs to last all day.

3.3 Why clothes hold scent longer than skin

People in India have known this for a long time. Attar, the traditional oil perfume, is often put on clothes, and many people notice that a shirt still smells of perfume the next day. There is a simple reason: skin is alive. Body heat, natural oils, sweat and movement all speed up evaporation. Fabric is not alive, so its fibers can trap fragrance molecules and hold them longer.

One fragrance company blog puts skin at roughly 6 to 24 hours and heavy natural fabrics like wool and thick cotton at 1 to 3 days, while synthetic fabrics like polyester hold scent for much less time. These are rough numbers from an industry source, not a lab study, but they match what most people experience. ScentStrip takes advantage of this by putting the fragrance on clothes instead of skin.

3.4 Why body heat helps

Warmer molecules move faster, and faster molecules escape into the air more easily. That is why a perfume smells stronger on a hot day. ScentStrip uses this on purpose. When the strip sits inside the collar, the warmth from your neck gently heats it, which pushes more fragrance out

than if the strip were sitting on a cold table. This is also why placement matters: the collar is warmer and closer to the nose than a jacket pocket.

3.5 The carrier: glycerin soap base

The fragrance needs something to live in. I chose clear glycerin melt and pour soap base because it is cheap, easy to buy in India, safe to handle, melts at a low temperature and sets into a flexible solid. It acts like a sponge that holds the oil and lets it out slowly.

During research I found a real problem with glycerin that I had not thought about. Glycerin is a **humectant**, which means it pulls water out of the air. In humid weather, melt and pour soap can "sweat": tiny drops of water form on the surface. Soap suppliers call this glycerin dew. India is humid for much of the year, so this matters a lot for a strip that sits in your collar.

The good news is that soap makers already know how to handle it. They use lower glycerin bases, wrap bars tightly, and store them in airtight containers with silica packets. For ScentStrip this means sealed foil packs, possibly a lower glycerin base, and a humidity test before launch.

3.6 How much fragrance goes in

Perfumes are classified by how much fragrance oil they contain. The rest is mostly alcohol.

Type	**Fragrance oil**
Parfum (extrait)	About 25 to 40 percent
Eau de Parfum (EDP)	About 15 to 17 percent (some brands go to 20)
Eau de Toilette (EDT)	About 10 percent
Eau de Cologne	About 5 to 8 percent
Normal melt and pour soap	About 3 percent
ScentStrip (my target)	**15 to 25 percent**

My first formula uses 40 g of soap base and 11 g of fragrance oil, which is about 22 percent. That is around seven times what a normal soap uses. I did this on purpose because in soap, scent is a bonus, but in ScentStrip, scent is the whole product.

I also have to be careful. Too much oil and the base cannot hold it, so the oil "weeps" out, the strip gets oily and it can stain clothes. My rule from testing guides is to never go above 25 percent, start around 20, and only go up if the scent is too weak. Also, comparing a solid strip to an EDP is not perfectly fair. EDP is diluted in alcohol that evaporates in seconds, while my strip is a solid. The percentage tells you how much fragrance is inside, not exactly how strong it will smell.

Temperature matters too. Fragrance oil starts to evaporate when the base is too hot, so you can lose scent before the strip even sets. Soap suppliers say to add fragrance below about 60°C (140°F), right before pouring. My process waits until the melted base cools to 55 to 60°C.

3.7 The adhesive

The adhesive was one of the hardest parts to get right. It has to stick firmly to fabric all day, peel off without leaving residue, and not lose its grip if you reposition it.

The answer is a **repositionable microsphere acrylic adhesive**. Instead of a flat layer of glue, it is made of tiny sticky balls. Only the tops of the balls touch the fabric, so it holds well but lets go cleanly. It is the same basic idea that makes a Post-it note stick and peel without damage.

I tested several real products before choosing:

Product	Result	Why
Nano gel grip tape	Rejected	It works by suction, which does not work on fabric because fabric has holes and is not smooth.
Carpet mesh mounting tape	Rejected	Permanent adhesive. It would leave residue and damage clothes.
SlickFix body tape	Approved	Made for fabric and skin, holds well and removes cleanly.
3M 238 Removable Double Sided Tape	Approved (best)	Removable, repositionable and easy to buy. Ideal for prototypes.

3.8 Doing the math on one strip

A strip that is 70 mm by 25 mm by 2 to 3 mm has a volume of about 3.5 to 5.3 cubic centimeters. Glycerin soap is a little heavier than water, so one strip weighs roughly 4 to 6 g. At 20 to 22 percent fragrance, that means each strip holds about **0.8 to 1.3 g of fragrance oil**.

That is a lot of fragrance for one day. My rough estimate is that a few morning sprays of EDP put well under 0.1 g of actual fragrance oil on you. So one strip holds many times more fragrance than a typical morning spray. The catch is that not all of it will come out in a day. Some will stay trapped in the strip. Finding the right balance, enough oil to smell strong but not so much that it is wasted or weeps out, is the main goal of my formula testing.

3.9 Future upgrade: microencapsulation

Big fragrance companies use a technology called microencapsulation, where fragrance is sealed inside tiny shells that can be smaller than a grain of dust. The shells break when they are rubbed or squeezed, releasing a burst of scent. It is used in scented clothing, sheets and towels, and some claim it survives many wash cycles.

I am not using this in version one because it needs a supplier and lab equipment. But it is a clear path for a later version: a strip that releases a fresh burst of scent every time you move, or even a strip that survives the laundry.

4. Building My First Prototype

I wanted to make the first strips myself with things I could order online in India. The full shopping list came to about **₹920 to ₹1,250**.

Item	Why I need it
Eclix ultra clear glycerin soap base	The carrier that holds the fragrance
Sandalwood fragrance oil	The scent. For prototypes only. For selling, I will switch to a skin safe, phthalate free oil with an IFRA certificate.
3M 238 removable double sided tape	The adhesive layer
Clazkit silicone tray	For testing formulas in small batches
0.1 g precision pocket scale	A normal 1 g kitchen scale is not accurate enough for fragrance oil. A 1 g error on an 11 g measurement is almost 10 percent.

4.1 The first formula (10 strips)

1. Cut 40 g of soap base into small cubes so it melts evenly.
2. Melt it in a glass bowl over a pot of hot water (a double boiler). Do not microwave it directly and do not let it boil.
3. Let the melted base cool to about 55 to 60°C.
4. Stir in 11 g of fragrance oil gently, about 22 percent of the total.
5. Pour into the mold and let it set at room temperature.
6. Wipe the bottom dry, let it cure, then apply the adhesive tape and cut to size.

4.2 A mistake I caught early

My first plan was to pour the strips in an ice cube tray. Then I realized the strips would come out far too thick to be a real product. Nobody wants a cube in their collar. The ice cube tray is fine for testing formulas, but for real strips I need to pour onto a flat silicone sheet or baking tray at 2 to 3 mm depth and cut them to size. Small decisions like this are why I prototype before I spend money on manufacturing.

4.3 The washing problem

A friend asked a good question: what happens when you wash the shirt? My answer for version one is simple and honest. You peel the strip off before washing, like you would take off a badge. I also plan to target outer layers first, like jackets, hoodies and jeans, which most people wash

less often and which push scent outward better anyway. A strip that survives washing is a future product, not a promise I will make now.

5. Problems I Found and How I Plan to Solve Them

A research paper that only lists good news is not research. These are the real risks I found, ranked from most serious to least.

Problem	Why it matters	My plan
1. Scent strength	A spray throws thousands of droplets into the air at once. A strip releases molecules slowly, so the peak smell is weaker. If customers expect a spray and get something faint, they will feel cheated. This is the one problem that could kill the idea.	High fragrance load (20 percent and up), collar placement for body heat, base note scents, and honest marketing as a close, personal scent rather than a room filling one. Test this first, before selling anything.
2. Fabric stains	One viral photo of a ruined white shirt could end the brand.	Never exceed 25 percent oil, cure strips fully, use a clean peel adhesive, and test on white cotton, white linen and black polyester for 24 hours.
3. Humidity sweating	Glycerin pulls water from the air. India is humid for much of the year.	Airtight foil packs with silica, test lower glycerin bases, and run a humidity test.
4. Scent "flattening"	In a solid, all the notes come out at the same time, so a complex perfume can smell flat.	Launch with simple one or two note scents like sandalwood, oud and fresh linen.
5. "Is this real perfume?"	Perfume has ritual and status: the bottle, the spray. A strip can feel cheap even if it is not.	Call it a wearable fragrance, not a sticker. Invest in packaging that feels premium. Tell the founder story.
6. Batch consistency	Hand mixed batches vary. If one pack smells weaker than the last, customers think the product got worse.	Use the 0.1 g scale, write down every temperature and weight, and turn it into a standard process I can hand to a manufacturer.
7. Repeat buying	A bottle running out reminds you to buy more. A strip pack might be forgotten.	Subscriptions and reminders two days before a pack runs out.

6. The Market

6.1 The global fragrance market

Fragrance is a big and growing business. One market research firm, P&S Intelligence, estimates the global fragrance and perfume market at about **US$60 billion in 2025**, growing to about **US$86.9 billion by 2032**, which is around 5.7 percent growth per year. The same report says

Asia Pacific is the fastest growing region, and it names India as the fastest growing country in that region.

6.2 The Indian perfume market

Another firm, IMARC Group, estimates the Indian perfume market at about **US$1.25 billion in 2025**, growing to about **US$2.0 billion by 2034**, around 5.4 percent a year. The reasons they give match what I see around me:

- More people in the middle class with money to spend on personal care.
- Fast growth of cities, where people care more about grooming and trends.
- Social media and influencers making fragrance feel aspirational, especially for younger buyers.
- Online shopping making fragrance easy to buy outside big cities.
- A huge gifting culture around festivals, weddings and work events.

Different research firms give different numbers, so I treat these as rough sizes, not exact facts. The direction is clear though: the market is large and growing, and India is one of the fastest growing parts of it.

6.3 What young buyers in India are doing

A 2026 fragrance trend report from Spate, covered by Cosmetech, points out a few things that matter for ScentStrip:

- **Pocket perfumes are especially popular among college students.** This tells me young people want fragrance that is cheap and easy to carry. That is exactly my target customer.
- **People are layering** body mists, perfumes and deodorants to build their own scent. A strip could be one more layer.
- **Price sensitive formats win.** Pocket perfumes and deodorants priced around ₹199 to ₹499 are where a lot of the action is. My pack price of ₹199 to ₹349 sits right in that range.
- **TikTok and Instagram are the new fragrance counters.** Fragrance is discovered on social media, which suits a new brand with no stores.

Big retailers are noticing too. Nykaa, one of India's largest beauty retailers, has said it sees body care and fragrance as its next big growth drivers.

6.4 Who I am building for

Customer	Why ScentStrip fits
College students	Want to smell good on a budget, already buy pocket perfumes, live on Instagram.

Customer	Why ScentStrip fits
Young professionals	Long days, commutes and meetings. Want scent that lasts without carrying a bottle.
Gym goers and travelers	Glass bottles are risky in a gym bag or on a flight. A flat foil pack is not.
Gift buyers	A small, affordable, nicely packaged gift for festivals, weddings and events.
People who find perfume too strong	Some people prefer a soft, close scent instead of a heavy spray.

7. Who Else Is Doing Something Similar

When I started, I hoped nobody had done this. That was naive. Scented products for clothes and wearable scent stickers already exist in different forms. What I have not found is a brand that sells a **daily, Eau de Parfum strength fragrance strip for clothes, at a mass price, for young Indian buyers.** That is the gap I am aiming for.

Competitor	What it is	How ScentStrip is different
Pocket perfumes (for example Engage, about ₹60 for 18 ml)	Small, very cheap spray cans that are popular with students.	They are probably cheaper per day, and I have to be honest about that. ScentStrip has to win on lasting longer without reapplying, not on price.
Budget bottles (Fogg, Engage, Nike, Davidoff)	₹400 to ₹1,800 per 100 ml bottle.	No glass, nothing to carry, and a higher fragrance concentration per use.
Designer perfume (Chanel, Dior, Tom Ford)	₹6,000 to ₹20,000 per bottle.	A small fraction of the daily cost, with no fragile bottle.
Attar and roll ons	Traditional oil perfume, often put on clothes.	Same idea of scent on clothes, but no oily spots on fabric and no mess.
Diptyque perfumed stickers	A luxury brand made decorative scented stickers that go on skin.	Proves big brands see value in wearable scent. ScentStrip goes on clothes and is priced for everyday use.
Fragrance patches (patents)	There are patent filings for "fragrance emitting patches".	Shows the general idea is not new, so my edge has to be the product, brand and price, not the concept.

What this tells me

The concept of wearable scent is already being tested by others, from cheap pocket sprays to luxury stickers. That is good news and bad news. Good, because it shows real demand for fragrance that is easy to carry. Bad, because I cannot rely on being the only one with the idea. My advantage has to come from a better product at the right price, a brand young people like, and moving fast.

8. Why I Believe This Can Work

Here are my reasons, each one connected to something real I found in my research.

Reason 1: The daily cost is much lower than a good perfume

If a designer bottle costs ₹6,000 to ₹20,000 and lasts two to four months of daily use, that is roughly **₹50 to ₹330 per day**. A ScentStrip pack at ₹199 to ₹349 for seven days is about **₹28 to ₹50 per day**, at Eau de Parfum strength. For someone who loves good fragrance but cannot afford designer bottles, that is a real difference.

Option	Price	Lasts about	Cost per day
Budget bottle	₹400 to ₹1,800	1 to 2 months	₹7 to ₹60
Designer bottle	₹6,000 to ₹20,000	2 to 4 months	₹50 to ₹330
ScentStrip pack	**₹199 to ₹349**	**7 days**	**₹28 to ₹50**

I want to be clear: ScentStrip is not cheaper than a budget bottle or a pocket perfume. Its value is being in the middle: much cheaper than designer perfume, but at a higher strength and with longer wear than most cheap sprays.

Reason 2: Clothes hold scent better than skin

This is not my opinion, it is how evaporation works. Skin is warm, oily and moving, so fragrance leaves it quickly. Fabric holds fragrance longer. People in India already put attar on clothes for this reason. ScentStrip builds a product around a behavior people already understand.

Reason 3: It solves the carrying problem completely

No glass, no liquid, no leaks. A pack of seven strips is flat and fits in a wallet. This matters for students, travelers and anyone who goes to the gym.

Reason 4: The market is growing, and India is growing fastest

Both the global and Indian fragrance markets are growing every year, and market reports name India as one of the fastest growing countries for fragrance. A new format has a better chance in a growing market than in a shrinking one.

Reason 5: Young buyers already want cheap, portable fragrance

Pocket perfumes being popular among college students proves the demand for affordable, carry anywhere scent. ScentStrip aims at that same need with a stronger, longer lasting product.

Reason 6: Big companies have a reason not to do this

Big perfume houses make their money on expensive bottles. A cheap daily strip could eat into their own sales, so they have little reason to push hard on this format. That leaves space for a small, fast brand.

Reason 7: It is cheap to make and cheap to test

My whole prototype cost about ₹1,000. The materials are ordinary, the process is simple, and I can test it with real people for very little money. If the idea fails, I lose almost nothing. If it works, I can scale it.

Reason 8: A pack that runs out every week is a business, not a one time sale

A bottle lasts months. A pack of strips lasts a week. That means customers come back often, which is perfect for a subscription. A product people buy every month is much more valuable than one they buy twice a year.

Reason 9: The science supports the core mechanism

Slow release from a solid carrier is not new science. Car fresheners, scented sachets and microencapsulated fabrics all use it. I am not inventing new chemistry. I am putting proven ideas into a new format for a new customer.

9. The Business Model

9.1 What I would sell

Product	**Price**	**Per strip**
7 strip pack (launch product)	₹199 to ₹249	₹28 to ₹36
15 strip travel pack	₹349 to ₹449	₹23 to ₹30
Monthly subscription (30 strips)	₹599 to ₹749	₹20 to ₹25
Premium scent pack (7 strips)	₹299 to ₹399	₹43 to ₹57
Gift box (mixed scents)	To be decided	For festivals and weddings

9.2 What one strip costs to make

These are my early estimates for making strips at a larger scale. Prototype costs are higher. I need real quotes from suppliers to confirm them.

Part	**Estimated cost per strip**
Glycerin soap base	₹2.50 to ₹4.00
Fragrance oil (15 to 25 percent)	₹6.00 to ₹12.00
Adhesive layer	₹1.50 to ₹3.00
Release liner	₹0.50 to ₹1.00
Packaging (share of a 7 strip foil pack)	₹2.00 to ₹3.50
Total	**₹12.50 to ₹23.50**

9.3 Does the math work?

Pack price	Price per strip	Gross margin if cost is ₹12.50	Gross margin if cost is ₹23.50
₹199	₹28.4	56%	17%
₹249	₹35.6	65%	34%
₹349	₹49.9	75%	53%

This table taught me something important. At ₹199 with high costs, the margin is too thin, because online marketplaces take a commission and I still have to pay for shipping and marketing. So my realistic launch price is closer to **₹249**, and getting the cost per strip down toward ₹12 to ₹15 through bulk buying is a top priority.

9.4 How I would sell it

- **My own website and Instagram first.** Direct sales keep the full margin and let me talk to every customer.
- **Campus sales.** As a student, I can sell to students directly, get fast feedback and build early word of mouth.
- **Marketplaces later.** Amazon, Flipkart and Nykaa once the product is proven, because that is where Indian shoppers already look.
- **Influencers.** Send packs to small fragrance and lifestyle creators. Fragrance is discovered on social media now.
- **Subscriptions.** A monthly pack delivered automatically solves the problem of people forgetting to reorder.

9.5 Business to business ideas

Some of the most interesting ideas are not about selling to individuals at all:

- **Fragrance sampling for perfume brands.** New perfume brands struggle to let people try their scent online. A strip with their fragrance could be a cheap, wearable sample that lasts a whole day instead of one spray on a paper card.
- **Wedding and event favors.** Indian weddings are big and gifting is part of the culture. Custom scented strips with a couple's names could be a unique favor.
- **Corporate gifting and hotels.** Branded scent packs for employees, clients or hotel guests.
- **White label.** Making strips for other brands to sell under their own name.

9.6 Where it could go next

1. **Version 1: the strip.** Prove that people want it and that it works.
2. **Version 2: wash surviving strips.** Using encapsulation technology so the strip can stay on through the laundry.
3. **Version 3: the clip.** A reusable clip with refillable scent cores. Sell the clip once, then sell refills every month.
4. **Version 4: global.** The problems of expensive, short lasting, fragile perfume are not just Indian problems.

10. Safety, Rules and Protecting the Idea

10.1 Fragrance safety (IFRA)

The International Fragrance Association (IFRA) sets safety limits on how much of each fragrance ingredient can be used in different kinds of products. It sorts products into 12 categories based on how much they touch the skin. For example, Category 4 is fine fragrance like perfume, and Category 11 covers products that touch the skin but transfer very little fragrance to it.

A strip inside a collar may brush against the neck, so I need to find out which category it really falls under. The simplest way to stay safe is to only buy fragrance oil from suppliers who give an **IFRA certificate** with every batch. That certificate tells me the maximum safe percentage for each category. If my 20 to 25 percent load is above the limit for my category, I have to lower it, even if the scent gets weaker. Safety comes first.

10.2 Indian rules for selling it

In India, cosmetics are covered by the Drugs and Cosmetics Act 1940 and the Cosmetics Rules 2020. Making cosmetics for sale needs a manufacturing licence from the state licensing authority. If I use a contract manufacturer, there is also a "loan licence" route for producing in someone else’s factory. Labels need things like the product name, manufacturer address, batch number, expiry date, net content and an ingredient list.

I am honestly not sure whether a fragrance strip that sticks to clothes counts as a cosmetic, because it is not applied to the body directly. Before I sell at any real scale, I will ask a regulatory expert. For now I am only making prototypes for testing.

10.3 Can I patent it?

Probably not the general idea. Scented sachets, car fresheners and scented laundry products have existed for decades, and there are already patent filings for fragrance emitting patches. On top of

that, I published the idea on my website in June 2026, which makes patenting the general concept even harder.

What might be protectable later is something specific I invent, like a unique clip design or a formula that measurably releases scent better than others. A design registration could protect how the product looks. I will talk to a patent agent before filing anything. For now, my real protection is **speed, brand and know how**: being first with a good product, building customers who trust me, and knowing the formula better than anyone copying it.

11. How I Will Test It

Dhandha has one rule: no idea stays in my head, and every result gets logged honestly, good or bad. Here is exactly how I will find out if ScentStrip works.

11.1 Where I am today

The ScentStrip landing page is live on my Dhandha website. It explains the product, the science and the price, and it has a feedback form where visitors pick a reaction and rate how likely they are to buy from 1 to 10. That form sends data to a real backend I built with Node.js, Express and MongoDB, with validation, rate limiting and other security in place.

So far I have **one real response**: a score of 9 out of 10 with the reaction "Interesting". One response proves nothing. It just means the system works and the real testing can start.

11.2 Lab tests (on my desk)

Test	How	Pass if
Scent strength	Wear a strip and have 3 people smell it at 1, 2, 4, 6 and 8 hours.	Clearly noticeable at 6 hours.
Stain test	Leave a strip on white cotton, white linen and black polyester for 24 hours, then peel.	No oil mark, no residue on any fabric.
Humidity test	Keep a strip in a closed box with a damp towel for 48 hours.	No visible sweating or dripping.
Peel test	Stick, peel and re-stick the same strip 5 times.	Still holds firmly after 5 times.
Heat test	Leave a sealed pack somewhere warm, like a car on a sunny day.	Strip keeps its shape and does not leak.
Blind comparison	Give 10 friends a strip and a pocket perfume, without telling them which is which, and ask which they prefer at the end of the day.	At least half prefer the strip.

11.3 Market tests (with real people)

Following my Dhandha process, I will share the page on Reddit, LinkedIn, Instagram and on campus with one honest question: "Would you use this?" Then I wait and look at the numbers. These are the targets I am setting for myself now, before I see the results, so I cannot move the goalposts later:

- At least **50 responses** in the first round.
- An average interest score of **7 or higher** out of 10.
- At least **30 percent** choosing "I need this".
- At least **20 people** leaving their email to hear about the launch.

11.4 The decision

Result	Decision
Targets hit and lab tests pass	**Pursue.** Make a small paid batch of 100 packs and sell them.
Interest is high but lab tests fail	**Park.** Fix the formula, then test again.
Interest is low	**Park or kill.** Log the result honestly and learn from it.

12. Roadmap

Phase	What I do	Goal
1. Formula	Make batches at 18, 20, 22 and 25 percent. Run all lab tests.	One formula that smells strong at 6 hours and never stains.
2. Validation	Share the landing page, collect feedback, give free strips to 20 people.	Hit the targets in section 11.3.
3. First sale	Make 100 packs by hand with proper labels and sell them to students and online.	Real paying customers and repeat orders.
4. Manufacturing	Get quotes from contract manufacturers, IFRA certified fragrance suppliers and regulatory advice.	Cost per strip near ₹12 to ₹15.
5. Scale	Launch on marketplaces and subscriptions, explore B2B sampling and gifting.	A repeatable, growing business.

13. Conclusion

ScentStrip started as a simple question: does fragrance have to be a liquid in a glass bottle? After months of research and prototyping, I believe the answer is no. The science is sound: fragrance is about controlled evaporation, clothes hold scent longer than skin, and body heat can do the work

of a spray. The market is large and growing, especially in India, and young buyers are already showing that they want fragrance that is cheap and easy to carry.

I also found real problems. Scent strength is the big one. Glycerin and humidity, fabric stains, safety limits and the "is this real perfume" question all need careful work. And the competition is real, from ₹60 pocket perfumes to luxury brands making scented stickers.

That is exactly why I am doing this the Dhandha way: build it, test it in public, and log the honest result. If ScentStrip works, it could make good fragrance affordable and easy for millions of people. If it does not, I will know why, and that knowledge will make my next idea better. Either way, the idea ships.

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